1. Draft your RAP

Name: _____ Partner: _____
Project: _____

Get started (3 minutes)

Exchange brief descriptions of your projects: the question, setting, and data. During peer feedback, write on your partner's sheet.

Draft independently (12 minutes)

Write one sentence for each component. Choose one R and P for the table, using brief phrases for alternatives below.

Component	Your current sentence
R: Research question What specific question will you answer?	
A: Answer or answer plan What do you find, or what analysis will answer R?	
P: Positioning statement What useful gap will your answer fill?	

If A is unknown, label it **planned** and specify the output and data or comparison. **Try two R variants: one that's more specific to focus the reader and one that's broader to highlight generality.**

Briefly describe why A is feasible given your understanding of the data and setting. Name one unresolved issue:

Try separate candidate P's for (1) economic theory, (2) policy, and (3) your understanding of the existing literature.

Perspective	Candidate contribution or gap
Economic theory	
Policy	
Existing literature	

2. Test and revise your RAP

Author: _____ **Reader:** _____

Exchange feedback (10 minutes)

Give each author **5 minutes**: the reader spends **2 minutes** reviewing page 1 and noting specific strengths or concerns below, then both spend **3 minutes** discussing a priority revision. Switch roles and repeat.

Check	Reader's feedback
R: Is it well defined and appropriately scoped?	
A and feasibility: Is the planned output clear and feasible? What needs checking?	
R and A: Would A or the proposed analysis directly answer R?	
P: Which candidate best explains why the answer matters? To which audience?	

Discuss: Does the project hinge on finding a specific direction of results? Or would the results be useful regardless of what they turn out to be?

Priority revision and reason:

Revise independently (5 minutes)

Incorporate the feedback to revise R, A, and P as needed.

	Revised sentence
R	
A and status	
P	

Class checkpoint: sharing revisions (5 minutes)

One volunteer who revised R shares the initial version, final version, and reason for the change. Another does the same for P. Discuss what each change gains or gives up.

A lesson I could apply to my own RAP: _____

3. Build an outline from your RAP

Name: _____ Project: _____

Draft independently (12 minutes)

Use your revised RAP to identify what the paper must establish. Focus on the body sections today. Start with the questions a reader needs answered, then give each question a place in the paper.

Use recognizable headings with specifics (e.g., “Data: Credit Bureau Panel”, “Empirical Strategy: Regression Discontinuity Around Loan Approval Threshold”). Label planned takeaways. Use more or fewer sections than the five rows below.

Body section heading	1-sentence takeaway
1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	
5.	

Explain one ordering choice: What must the reader understand before reaching a later section?

The section most important to develop next, and why:

4. Read your partner's outline

Author: _____ **Reader:** _____

Exchange feedback (10 minutes)

Give each author **5 minutes**: **2 minutes** to skim the revised RAP and outline, then **3 minutes** to discuss one potential structural change. Switch roles and repeat.

- Does each section help answer R, support the answer, or explain its importance?
- Does an important reader question lack a home?
- Does a section depend on a definition or assumption explained later?
- Does each takeaway answer the question its heading raises?
- Are findings distinguishable from plans and unknowns?

One section to keep, and the job it does:

The most important unanswered question: Name the section that raises it, or where an answer should appear.

One structural change to try: Move, rename, add, combine, split, or remove a section. Explain which reader question this would help answer.

Author: the change I will make, or why I will keep the current structure:

5. Develop one part of your outline

Name: _____ **Project:** _____

Work independently (8 minutes)

2 minutes: revise your outline using page 4. **4 minutes:** expand one section takeaway. **2 minutes:** sketch one supporting subsection or paragraph.

Section heading: _____

Reader question: _____

Section takeaway: Expand page 3's sentence into 3–4 rough sentences: the main message, high-level support, and link to RAP. If results are pending, describe the planned analysis.

Supporting subsection heading: _____

Question it answers: _____

Supporting message or plan: Sketch one sentence developing the section's message. If no subsection is needed, write a supporting paragraph's topic sentence.

One piece of evidence, definition, or assumption needed beneath these takeaways:

6. Revise and choose your next steps

Author: _____ Reader: _____

Final peer check and individual revision (10 minutes)

Spend **3 minutes on each author's work**: read the revised RAP, outline, and section takeaway, then suggest one priority change. **Both revise independently for 4 minutes**.

Reader: the most important issue to resolve and my suggested change:

Author: record one consequential revision. Revise earlier pages, including RAP, as needed.

Before: heading or sentence	After: revised version

This revision helps the reader understand...

Next steps (5 minutes)

Check: revised RAP, headings with takeaway sentences, and one developed section with a supporting idea.

Based on the outline, reflect on the highest priority items to complete. Is there anything the outline exercise suggests you should prioritize? Or deprioritize?

List two next actions in priority order and their outputs:

Priority	Action and question it resolves	Concrete output
1.		
2.		

One task I will defer or drop because it contributes less to RAP:
